A GLOBAL CLASS

WHAT IT WILL TAKE FOR INDIA TO MAKE A GIANT LEAP IN EDUCATION INSTEAD OF INCREMENTAL CHANGE

By KAUSHIK DEKA

INDIA'S HIGHER EDUCATION SYSTEM STANDS AT A CROSSROADS. IT HAS THE POTENTIAL TO BE A GLOBAL leader, and significant progress has been made in that direction, but addressing the challenges of access, quality, research and employability is crucial for the system to realise its full potential. The National Education Policy (NEP) 2020 provides a robust framework for these reforms. It aims to transform the education system by promoting internationalisation, reducing the emphasis on rote learning and encouraging multi-disciplinary courses. The NEP also focuses on improving faculty-student ratios, enhancing research funding and fostering a culture of research and innovation. However, the successful implementation of this policy, as many have concluded, will require the coordinated effort of the government, the institutions and the private sector.

To transform its higher education landscape and secure its place as a global leader in education and development, India must foster a culture of critical thinking and innovation as well ensure equitable access to quality education. One of the critical pillars for facilitating this change is the university ecosystem, which, in the long run, will determine the economic strength of a country.

Japan, Singapore, Hong Kong, Taiwan and South Korea, for instance, are Asian nations that have significantly invested in enhancing both the quality and the accessibility of their university systems. This strategic investment has allowed them to overcome the middle-income trap and attain advanced levels of development. China, in particular, has been aligning its higher education with international standards since the 1980s, accounting for its leading position among Asian countries in university rankings. India, by



WINNING WITH WISDOM Students at Delhi's Jawaharlal Nehru University

CHANDRADEEP KUMAR